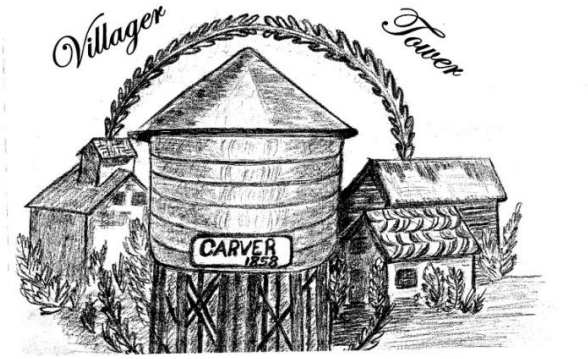
Volume XXX
Number Two Hundred Seventy Nine
January/February 2012



The Past

As the editor/owner of the "*Villager Tower*" I would like to explain its absence for the last three months. We are all too aware of how shaky the economy is. As I have mentioned previously, the trickle down effect is difficult on every business in every aspect in all walks of life. Thereby, begging for meager crumbs from our supportive and generous sponsors also proves to be quite difficult and quite time consuming. Time was not in abundance in my life in the past several months either. Priorities refused to allow me the luxury of the ability to compose, create and produce a newsletter. I apologize but I cannot make myself become four people. I trust all will understand. We will get back on track here this thirtieth year of production. The '*Carver Current*' was ever so obliging to keep you all up to date on events of importance and I thank Dan for all his time and efforts.

Dan has also informed me that the Carver County Historical Society is very interested in archiving the past issues of the newsletter. How cool is that? Each and every issue is also available for your review on the website, "*Carver Current*'.

How sad it is then that I had to miss a beat and forfeit the last several months. Oh well, life goes on and "it is what it is". Just proves how little control we, as humans, have in our own destinies Just try our best and keep putting one foot in front of the other and don't give up!

.....

The Future

From Diane Hoglin – "Start year with Fresh 'ingredients'

"The new year. It's the time for a fresh and start and I'm ready to try to make 2012 a great one!"
She says, "My plans for the new year are to take life one day at a time and live it to the best of my ability, to try to laugh when I'd rather cry, to reach out my hand to someone in need, to overlook the faults I see in others for none of us is perfect and to promote peace and live in my own small corner of the world."
"May the grateful spirit and awesome wonder of the upcoming year take hold in each of our hearts. May love and laughter linger each and every day."
This was just too neat to not share with the readers from this person. She included the recipe as follows, as well. We should all follow and make her recipe. What a better and wonderful place we would all be in if we followed her advice.
"New Year Miracle recipe"
"1 part of knowing who you are.
"1 part of knowing who are aren't
"1 part of knowing what you want
"1 part knowing who you wish to be
"1 part knowing what you already have before you
"1` part of choosing wisely from what you have before you
"1 part of loving and thanking for all you have

"Mixing instructions: Combine ingredients together gently and carefully. Using faith and vision, mix together with strong belief of the outcome, until finely blended. Use thoughts, words and actions for best results. Bake until blessed. Give thanks again. Yields unlimited servings."
Thank you Ms Hoglin. [Compliments of the Brainerd Paper]

.....

"In the final analysis it is not what you do for your children but what you have taught them to do for themselves that will make them successful human beings." ..... Ann Landers

Important Past Updates

October Highlights 2011

In the beginning of October at the council meeting the County Commissioner Mr Maluchnik updated the council on county activities. These included the statement that the county had been able to decrease the tax on county properties. The county has joined the facebook network. Carver County is been named one of the top counties for job increases from 2001 to 2010. County Road updates were given to the council. Questions were asked of the commissioner and he would respond back to the council when he got answers.

Also at the October meeting The Carver County Attorney gave information to the council on the attorney's office such as employee data and services provided. The county's attorney's office is the largest law firm in Carver County.

The council adopted the resolution providing for the sale of General Obligation Improvement Bonds to be used to finance costs associated with the construction of the Levi Griffin Road and related improvements. A Conditional Use Permit for Dacotah Furniture resolution was also adopted for manufacturing wood furniture.

The City Planner told the council about amendments to the Comprehensive Plan and the Park Dedication Study. These amendments included updates to the Comprehensive Plan involving systems statements, grade-separated crossings and the river over look on the Minnesota River.

The Carver Scott Humane Society held a fundraiser at the Mustard Seed at the request of the Carver County Land Management Office for a Special Event Permit.

Woodrow "Woody" Swanson Field Dedication

The Park and Recreation Supervisor informed the council that the Carver Black Sox requested field dedication to a former resident. They have requested that the Community Park Baseball Field be named in honor of 'Woody Swanson'. This request would honor the gentlemen who organized and founded the Carver Black Sox baseball team in the city in 1948. His contribution to the City of Carver includes service on the Carver Fire Department, the City Council and the Carver Lions Club. Woody is a Black Sox Hall of Famer and has been inducted into the State Baseball Hall of Fame. As founder of the team, the Carver Black Sox express their strong desire to honor his name by dedicating the field to him.

The Park Board approved the proposal for this dedication of the Community Park Baseball Field. Motion was made and carried with all ayes dedicating the Community Park Baseball Field as "*Woodrow 'Woody' Swanson Field*'.

Community Park Warming House

Check the City of Carver's website for updated schedules and postings. As the temperatures drop the possibility of being able to skate and play hockey improves. Weekdays, 5 PM to 9 PM, Saturdays, 11 AM to 9 PM and Sundays 1 PM to 8 PM.
Saturdays and Sundays from 4 PM to 5 PM Leisure Skating Only.

"Friendship is not about who you have known the longest. It's about those who come and never left your side."

Highlights from November 2011

As an alternate revenue option the city will research the possibility of a Municipal Liquor Store. A feasibility report would be required as well as a Notice of Intention to establish a municipal liquor operation be published.

The council reviewed and discussed several items of their 2012 water and sewer budgets at a November meeting. This would be the first budget for the Storm Sewer Fund. There was a request for monies for the installation of a gate structure at the Depot Park to alleviate water problems experienced in the area. Grant programs were being researched for funding of such a problem.

Discussions were also held in November regarding sharing equipment with other government agencies. Discussions were held with others to field willingness for such an arrangement. There were two government units interested in joint ventures.

An Ehlers representative reviewed fees and rates in a continued discussion with the council at the November meeting. An Analysis for 2012 Utility Rates and Development Fees had been prepared. Proposals included increases by percentages to begin every other year eliminating monthly rates beginning in the year of 2013, with no change to water rate structure, sewer rates on the similar formula, storm water charge for 2012 not to increase, municipal utilities connection fees increase with specific formula and decrease the sewer fee connection formula as the city fee would be reduced when the Metropolitan Council begins their connection fee for sewer connections. An annual review of rates would allow the city to respond to new information.

A Public Hearing had been held in November regarding Assessments for the Carver Interceptor Project. The attorney reviewed the past steps taken. A feasibility report on downtown improvements had been done. Construction on Segment A , the downtown improvements had been started in 2009, along with lines, lift stations, storm sewer, new curb and gutter, street, sidewalk and streetscape. The engineer shared photos of accomplished work. Presently assessment hearings reviewing the costs to be assessed was now being conducted. Many residents were in attendance to discuss the assessments and imbalances involved in assessments. The end process of the Public Hearing was the council accepting the resolution the council deemed the fairest as Option A adopting the assessment.

Also at the November meeting the Parks and Recreation Supervisor reviewed with the council the continuing community park plans. A Park Dedication Study had been adopted in 2010. This plan along with Comprehensive Plan facilitates the collection of fees for outfitting current and future parks. This study identifies the differences in the park classifications, more specifically serves as a guide for future growth of the entire park system. Resident input was also heard by the council.

At the November Work Session the council reviewed and discussed law enforcement issues. Deputy Lessard expressed his desire to continue working in the city. At the work session the council also reviewed and discussed the city's 'Mission Statement' committee. Incorporating the strategic planning areas was worked on by the committee. The proposed statement: *"We will advocate for the City of Carver by being accountable to community stakeholders, maintaining infrastructure, protecting resources, respecting our history and planning for our future."*

The City Planner discussed amendments proposed to the Comprehensive Plan. The city is required to amend the plan due to a revised system statement that includes changes to the regional transportation and parks policy plans that impact the city. The amendment adds regional trail search corridor. The council accepted adoption of the resolution amending the Comprehensive Plan related to parks.

The council also discussed in November the Park Dedication study including an underpass and the river over look project. The additional two projects resulted in trail component park dedication fees to be increased. The Planning Commission reviewed and recommended approval of the updated Park Dedication Study.

The council discussed at length the change order involving the Freeway Commercial District involving County Road # 11 and County Road # 61. The county staff indicated proceeding with right of way acquisition is in progress and the portion of part of the project will not begin until next year, easements will be pursued. The project plans to start in the spring of 2012.

December 2011 Highlights

The Truth in Taxation Public Hearing had been held in December. Ehlers Financial Consultant reviewed with the council the Municipal Utilities Rate Study. The goals of this study are to ensure rates are sufficient for payment of ongoing operations and capital improvements, as well as maintaining adequate cash balances and to ensure current and future needs are being met. The rate structure distributes operating system costs and is consistent with the policy objectives of the council. Rate recommendations were reviewed and discussed. Resolution was adopted relating to water, sewer and storm water utility rates and connection fees. The council reviewed their annual fee ordinance for the upcoming year. The council reviewed and adopted the resolution involving the city's new mission statement.

The city had previously expressed its intent to preserve the Main Street West railroad bridge. The bridge would be donated. The city would be responsible for continuing maintenance and assume all liability for the bridge. Final details were to be handled by the attorney and the administrator.

The council reviewed and discussed amendments to the Employee Reference Manual proposed. The council also discussed time changes relating to meeting times. The Fire Department Board has been meeting discussing negotiating the fire contract and progress at the meeting. Mills Fleet Farm updates were reported to the council.

In other related community issues happening in December include the auditions held for the Chaska Family Theater's production of "*Oliver*". Rehearsals are scheduled to begin in January. Eight performances are planned for March 16th – March 25th. Watch for future posting and updates on this item.

MN Firefighter Service Foundation Memorial

The Minnesota Fire Fighter Service Foundation Memorial that would Honor Our Fallen... down at the Capitol grounds needs to raise $ 600,000 by December 31, 2011.

Since 1881, one hundred and ninety four Minnesota firefighters have died in the line of duty, according to the Minnesota Fire Service Foundation. In July, [2011] the Blaine-based nonprofit launched a fundraising initiative to build a memorial on the State Capitol grounds to honor those fallen firefighters. Firefighters from across the state gathered at the Chanhassen Fire Station stating that the $600,000 fundraising goal set for the Minnesota Fallen Firefighter Memorial had been exceeded. Construction is scheduled to begin in spring.

From the "*Firehouse*"; the closest thing to a memorial for the state's fallen firefighters is a bronze sculpture that has stood for more than 20 years near the baggage claim at Minneapolis-St. Paul International Airport.
"The sculpture doesn't say anything about who those people were or when they died," said Eden Prairie Fire Chief George Esbensen, the foundation's president. "It's a very nice sculpture that only tells part of the story."

Firefighters have pushed for a larger, more accessible memorial for about a decade, after legislation set aside land on Capitol grounds. About seven years ago, the foundation failed to rally support and funds for a memorial from the public. This time around, it took a different approach: It asked each of the state's more than 20,000 firefighters to pitch in $30 apiece. It worked, Esbensen said; firefighters raised more than 80 percent of the total.
"Our strategy was by firefighters, for firefighters," he said.
The cost to build the memorial is pegged at $500,000, with the remaining $100,000 to be placed in a maintenance fund for the memorial, as required by state law for a memorial placed on State Capitol grounds. With more than half the state's 790 fire departments donating, the foundation's goal is to get every department to contribute something,

"So that everybody can say they had a hand in this," Esbensen said. Leftover money will go toward the foundation's primary mission: to provide scholarships for children of active, retired or fallen firefighters, Esbensen said. The bronze firefighter sculpture is incorporated into the design of the new memorial, to be built in the southwest corner of the Capitol grounds. Esbensen said the plan is to dedicate the memorial during National Fallen Firefighters Memorial Weekend, set for October 6th and 7th.

Carver Youth Baseball Softball Association

Submitted By: Jane C. Thon

As you know, we lost one of our coaches this last July. A plaque will be placed on Community Field #4, identified as "Mosley Field". You can view the plaque on the city's website in the December newsletter if you have computer access.

Something new we have for 2011 is we have reserved the Carver Gym on Sunday afternoon from 4 PM to 6 PM starting January 8th through April 29th, (except February 19th) for Softball/Baseball practices. We will also need adult volunteers to supervise practices.

Registrations will be open starting in January. If you have been part of our program last year you will be receiving notices via our registration vendor – "Sports Signup" providing you with much needed information.

Our home web page will be updated as information becomes available. If you are new to the area and would like information on our programs, our web page can be accessed at: www.cityofcarver.com. On the left side select "Local Athletic Associations", then select CCYBSA – Carver Community Youth Baseball Softball Association. If you do not computer access, contact the city and they will direct you to the appropriate personnel.

Anyone who registered with 'our' system last year, all you need to do is return to your account, sign in, and continue to register for 2012. The system will display the programs (based on the information from last year) your child can register for. Current session information is on the' left hand side'. 2012 updated information from the association is on the right hand side.

Spring 2012 is fast approaching and we are looking forward to having you in our program.

Babysitting Clinic

The Parks and Recreation Babysitting Clinic for kids eleven and older is scheduled for January 30th at 4:30 PM to 8:30 PM at the Fire Station. Contact Kristy Peterson at the Parks and Recreation for more information. This accredited program teaches to keep you and the children you care for safe. Learn skill training and information that is necessary in caring for infants/children. Teaches the importance of responsibility, recognizing an emergency, emergency action steps, personal, fire, and water safety, basic care, responding to an unconscious victim, rescue breathing, choking management and basic first aid. Upon successful completion, participants will earn the American Health and Safety Institute Child and Babysitting Safety Certification. Also scheduled for Monday, June 27 at the Carver Hall.

Carver Fire Department

The council discussed the Fire Departments need for new air bottles before expiration for the Self Contained Breathing Apparatus. A grant had been applied for. If the city were to purchase these bottles before grant approval, then the fire department becomes ineligible for the grant. The department and the administrator are researching renting the air bottles prior to grant approval or denial.

The council most recently heard the most recent request from the Fire Department regarding replacement of failing equipment, specifically the breathing apparatus. The grant applied for was not awarded to the department according to the representatives attending the meeting asking the council to authorize a loan from the Storm Sewer Fund which would be repaid. Terms of the loan were detailed in a resolution. The term of the loan were discussed further. Motion was made and carried with all ayes authorizing an inter-fund loan from the Storm Sewer Fund to the General Fund. Motion was also made and carried with all ayes authorizing the purchase of the SCBA units.

Disclaimer

The "unapproved" minutes of the council and the township have been referenced for the purpose of creating this information for residents in the City of Carver and the townships surrounding the city.

"Life is what happens to you while you're busy making other plans. ……. – John Lennon

Highway # 212 Signage Plan

The engineer explained the signage issue with the city. Exit signs off of the new Highway # 212 do not indicate exits to downtown Carver and Chaska. Neither city contacted the state regarding permanent signs displaying directional information to each city. The two cities will work together on signage and then the county will acquire the signs. The council also discussed the Mt Hope Road sign off of County Road #61. This road does indicate an entrance to the downtown area of Carver. Arrow signs were discussed indicating directional locations sites. The engineer will continue working on this item with the City of Chaska.

The council further discussed placement of permanent signs on the new highway. The Chaska staff was still in the process of reviewing the City of Carver proposed submissions. The cities will continue communicating with the county and the state and the staff of both cities. The council was also told that there may be some costs associated with permanent signs.



2011 Carver Heritage Preservation Award

Craig Norby of Madison River Ventures Inc is the recipient of the 2011 Carver Heritage Preservation Award for his restoration of the 1898 Charles L. Dauwalter Queen Anne Victorian House at 413 Broadway in downtown Carver. The award is given annually for the year's best preservation work in the Carver Historic District, which is on the National Register of Historic Places.

In 2011 the Carver brick home was in foreclosure and had suffered from years of neglect, lack of funds, and ill-advised remodeling when Craig Norby of Excelsior, Minnesota acquired the home and began restoration of the building. The house was again converted to its original configuration as a single family residence.

The Charles L. Dauwalter Jr. House was built in 1898 by Charles L. Dauwalter Jr., the son of Charles D. Dauwalter Sr., a pioneer Carver settler, who arrived in Carver in 1857. Charles Dauwalter Jr. was born in Carver in 1867 and was apprenticed at age 15 in his father's blacksmith and wagon making shop, later becoming proprietor of the business, which was located next door to his house, and which in 1913 he converted into a Buick automobile dealership, the first in Carver, and among the earliest in Carver County. Later the business was expanded as a Buick-Chevrolet dealership and survives to the present in the Lenzen Buick-Chevrolet dealership in Chaska.

The house is built of buff-colored Carver brick and features Queen Anne Victorian and Eastlake design elements, is 2 ½ stories high with a multi-gabled roof, a full front porch, limestone windowsills, stained glass decorative windows, and three picture windows. The Charles Dauwalter Jr. House was featured in the 1978 Minnesota State Historic Preservation Office book, *Carver County: A Guide to its Historic and Prehistoric Places,* by Lofstrom and VanBrocklin-Spaeth.

Craig Norby was presented a plaque at the first January 2012 Carver City Council meeting. For those interested, the house is on the market and for sale.

More information about the history of Carver and the buildings in the Carver Historic District can be found by going to the City of Carver website at (www.cityofcarver.com) and following the Boards and Committees/Heritage Preservation/History of Carver links, or by going to the Carver Current website at (http://carvercurrent.com/) and clicking on the "History" link at the top.



"I can only please one person today.

"Today is not your day.

"Tomorrow is not looking good either."

Metropolitan Council Environmental Services Interceptor

The City Planner discussed with the council the updates regarding charges and transitions for the Metropolitan Council Environmental Services Interceptor project. Completion is scheduled for fall of 2012. The planner also explained that the practice of collecting MCES Sewer Availability Charges, also known as 'SAC' or 'connection charges' are begun one year prior to the flow of the system commencing. This prompted a meeting with staff to begin the transition process. This transition period involves some transitioning of its own for variables not previously anticipated. Information given to the staff involved additional overview of requirements regarding inventories to be completed, ordinance amendments, and processes required. These also concerned structures under construction.

This process has the staff evaluating a number of properties and discerning payments and billing evaluations. The staff is also reviewing the MCES SAC Procedures Manual, along with other relevant documents and statutes . The staff is also completing an analysis of the financial impact and units affected. Because of this transition process and fees, some of the information had not been included in the financial analysis prepared by the financial consultant for the sewer capital fund. The council discussed the challenges to determine the charges beginning with the MCES.

Municipal Liquor Store

An interest was expressed in at least an investigative nature for a preliminary basis, the feasibility of establishing a municipal liquor store. The council reviewed with the attorney the addressing legal, liability and some limited operations issues. This discussion and reviewal did not address the financial feasibility. Population conditions, time restraints, voter authorization, profitability, licensing and purchase requirements were all discussed. The attorney pointed out that an operation of this type exposes the city to the same types of risk and liability as a private establishment. Therefore the council continued reviewal of the statistics of the financial responsebility, insurance and liability. Operation violations, issues, security, employees, management and internal accounting were all also looked at. A presentation was given focusing on preparations, initial steps necessary in order to conduct informed decisions and risk management. Such an endeavor would be a challenging decision. The pros and cons were all looked at. The city council will consider authorizing a proposal to conduct a market study on the viability of municipal off-sale liquor.

Sixth Street / Dahlgren Road and Jonathan Carver Parkway

The city engineer discussed a resolution prepared for Carver County to add right and left lanes at the intersection of Sixth Street /Dahlgren Road and Jonathan Carver Parkway. Monies had been approved by legislature involving state transportation road funds in the Local Road Improvement Program. These funds are to assist townships, cities and counties for construction or reconstruction of local road projects with statewide and regional significance. MN Dot State Aid for local transportation is soliciting these governmenttal units and other local agencies to submit eligible projects for funding for 2012/2013. The submission criteria was reviewed. The county has discussed this issue previously. The county also indicated attempting to obtain funding through this program and the city's support is being asked for on their application. Since it is a county project, there are not any costs associated to the city expected. However, the county anticipates the necessity for additional right of way and the drainage improvements. Staff was recommending forwarding a resolution of support to the county for their request. Motion was made and carried with all ayes authorizing the staff to draft a letter and/or the resolution to be forwarded to the county personnel adding the right and left turn lanes at the intersection of Sixth Street/Dahlgren Road and Jonathan Carver Parkway/County Road # 11.

Time Changes ~ Council Meetings

Please make note. The council meeting times have been changed to begin at 7 PM instead of 6:30 PM. Hopefully this time will be more accommodating to the public. The meetings are held at Carver-On-The-MN on 109 Main Street East. Work sessions will be held at 5:30 PM, the third Monday of the month (unless it falls on a holiday, then the council will meet on the following Tuesday). Regular council meetings will be held the first and third Monday of the month at 7 PM.

Main Street Bridge Lighting

The council revisited the issue of the street lighting on the Main Street Bridge. The topic had been discussed last summer. Several options had been proposed for council consideration. Three options were recently discussed. They were standard acorn light near the bridge; stone base and bollard light; or a stone base with acorn street light. Costs were reviewed. Lighting is not eligible for bridge bonding or county reimbursement. Bonding had been sought. The city needs to identify other funding sources if this item is to be pursued. Adjustments are also necessary. The Heritage Preservation Commission had previously approved work on the bridge and provided feedback on salvaged stone. Lights should also be reviewed by the Heritage Preservation Commission. The staff reviewed the associated costs related to adding street lights for the Main Street Bridge and are to provide direction to the engineer as plans are finalized for bidding purposes.

Federal Highway Administration

The engineer discussed adopted new guidelines by the Federal Highway Administration regarding the maintenance of street signs. Recently there was a proposal eliminating some requirements. An extension has not been issued presently the council was told. The League of MN Cities provided updates. Suggestion was submitted that the city adopt the policy prior to finalization.

The policy involves street sign inventory, retro-reflectivity compliance evaluation and replacement policy. The engineer presented a drafted policy for the council's review outlining inventory, retro-reflectivity, compliance evaluation and the replacement policy. Recommendation to the council was to approve the draft policy aware of possible changes necessary upon final rules adopted by the Federal Highway Administration.

Caucuses

The Caucuses are coming! The Minnesota caucuses will be held on February 7th at 7 PM. Precinct caucuses are meetings organized by Minnesota's political parties to begin the process of selecting candidates for the 2012 election and policy positions to shape the party platform. These are open to the public. In order to vote, offer resolutions, become a delegate at a precinct caucus, attendees must be eligible to vote in the 2012 election, live in the precinct and be in general agreement with the principles of the political party. This year political parties will conduct a straw poll to gauge caucus attendee's presidential candidate preference. The Republican, Independence, Green, Democratic and Constitution parities will hold caucuses on Tuesday, February 7th. The two parties not holding caucuses in 2012 is the Libertarian and the Grassroots parties.

For your convenience: listed below are the political parties meeting sites for caucuses.

The Constitution Party meeting in Redwood Falls, 507.644.3183; Democratic party meeting in St Paul at 255 East Plato Blvd, 651.293.1200 ; Green Party meeting at 180 East 5th Street, Suite #222 in St Paul, 651.288.2820; the Independence Party will also meet in St Paul, street address was not available at publishing time, phone 651.487.9700for more information; the Republican party will be meeting at 525 Park St, Suite # 250 in St Paul, 651.222.0022; and last but not least, the Whig Party will be meeting in Rochester, also no street address available, no phone number available either, you can however, go to their website; 222.mnw2higs.org.

Drawing for the Graphic Artist

The Parks and Recreation Department is offering "Drawing for the Graphic Artist" on February 13th and 20th from 6 to 8 PM at the Carver Hall. Graphic Designers, artists, and art directors conceptualize, produce design concepts and perform a variety of duties involved in the layout of printed and graphic materials. In order to accomplish this task, these artists must understand drawing, the basic skill of any career in art. This new course from Young Rembrandts offers students an opportunity to learn drawing concepts that are basic for anyone exploring the graphic arts. Also offering instruction in perspective, advertising layout, art history and an introduction to cartooning. Ages 3rd – 6th grade

"Every Exit is an Entry Somewhere Else."

- Tom Stoppard

Carver Fire Relief Association Annual Steak Fry

Join the Carver Fire Relief Association for their annual Steak Fry!
Friday, February 3 4:00pm – 9:00pm Carver Hall 316 Broadway
Adults – $12.00 / Kids $4.00
Silent Auction to help raise funds for the Carver Fire Relief Association. Kid's entertainment with: Barb Mawer of Party Bags To Go, LLC www.mn.partybagstogo.com. And a live D.J!
Companies interested in advertising or donating to the silent auction, please contact:
Nate Lindall – 952-715-0224 nlindall@gmail.com



Community Calendar February 2012

February 1st - Business Group Meeting
Lions Meeting
February 2nd - Ground Hog Day
Drill Night
February 3rd - Happy Birthday Darrel!
February 6th - Council Meeting 7 PM
February 7th - Caucuses
February 8th - Late Start – East Union Elementary
Tug Boat Committee Meeting
February 9th - Happy Birthday Brenna!
February 10th - Happy Birthday Adam!
Happy Birthday Tommy!
East Union Carnival
February 12th - Lincoln's Birthday
February 13th - Dahlgren Township Board Meeting
Happy Birthday Maddie!
East Union PTO Meeting
February 14th - Valentine's Day
Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
February 15th - Lions Meeting
Happy Birthday Kim!
Happy Anniversary Dwight and Janet!
Happy Birthday Katie!
February 16th - Planning Commission Meeting
Happy Birthday Tom!
Happy Birthday Bob!
February 17th - Happy Birthday Bruce!
February 18th - Happy 90th Birthday Merva!
February 20th - Washington's Birthday
President's Day
Happy Birthday Tom!
February 21st - Council Meeting 7 PM
Drill Night
Happy Birthday Peggy!
February 21st - Mardi Gras
February 22nd - Ash Wednesday
Happy Birthday Sandra!
February 23rd - Fire Department Meeting Night
Happy Birthday Faye!
February 27th - Park and Recreation Board Meeting
Happy Birthday Dad!
Bloodmobile – Chaska VFW
February 28th - East Union 4th/5th Grade Band Concert

Dorothy and Sara / Mother and Daughter

Is your child a student in District # 112? Your child ride the bus? Maybe your child knows Dorothy. Dorothy is a mom, grandmother and school bus driver for Eastern Carver County School District. So you all can relate to her dismay when you think about your own children. They are having a fundraiser for 'Sara' and the flyer is attached. If you can help, please do. Say a prayer for the entire family. Things happen to people and families that touch our lives closer than you think. Sara is also a mom. Thank you for just your thoughts, if that's all you can do. The miracle of prayers is stronger than you can imagine!!!!

"Easy is right. Begin right and you are easy. Continue easy and you are right. The right way to go easy is to forget the right way and forget that the going is easy."

……- Chuang – Tzu……

What's New?

Valentine's Day, February 14th



"I know it must seem much too early to be talking about Valentine's Day, but believe me when I say that by the time the next monthly e-mail newsletter comes out Valentine's Day will already be over. Our. Valentine's Day décor is already up at the shop, our roses are pre ordered and our postcards are going out this week to all the male customers we have in our database. We're hoping for a very good Valentine's Day this year.

Yes, we will have one dozen red roses arrangements, but we will have so much more ~ lilies, tulips, daisies and mixed bouquets a variety of colorful floral designs in all price ranges from $ 15 on up. So watch for our postcard, if you place your order before January 31st, you can save 15%.

The Carver Craft Group started to meet in January. By the end of their meeting the participants will have decided what their February project will be. Everyone is welcome. If you haven't started, just stop in and talk with Annette or if you would like to join in next month, February, just drop an e-mail or call her at 952.681.7582. You will be put on the notification list. Each month will be something different and will give us some new activities and new acquaintances to help to make the winter pass more quickly. Classes are all directed by a knowledgeable instructor, and supply lists will be published ahead of time so that participants can either buy the materials themselves to bring to the class or we can try to have the materials available on site for purchase. The classes will meet the third Tuesday of every month at 6:30 PM at the Carver Country Flowers and Gifts. Class fee is $ 5.00, plus the cost of supplies. Refreshments are also served.
Annette Hentz at Carver Country Flowers & Gifts
Named 2010 Retailer of the Year by the MN State Florist Assn
109 3rd Street EastP. O. Box 156,Carver, MN 55315, 952-681-7582
www.carverflowers.com; now on Facebook! Become a fan!
www.facebook.com/CarverFlowers; follow us on Twitter!
www.twitter.com/carverflowers

Black Sox Spring Bingo

Get ready for the spring get together with the Carver Black Sox. They are making preparations for their Spring Bingo. Friday, March 30th at the Carver Village Hall from 7 to 11 PM.. The festivities include door prizes, meat raffles, Turkey and Ham Bingo. Food and beverages available, along with lots of fun will be had by all. Cheesey Vegetable Soup will be available for those during the Lenten season. Come out for a night of fun. Bring the kids. It is fun for all ages !!!! You could win a turkey or ham for your Easter dinner. See you there!

Carver- On-The-Minnesota Inc Silent Auction Items Wanted

The non-profit group Carver-on-the-Minnesota, Inc will be holding a 'Silent Auction' in conjunction with the Carver Loins Pork Chop Dinner at the Carver Village Hall on Friday, April 27th, 2012. Auction items, services, event tickets, antiques, etc are now being solicited. It's a great opportunity to showcase and advertise businesses and products, while at the same time benefitting Carver. Donated items are tax deductible and auction proceeds go directly to the benefit of Carver. Donated items may be dropped off during normal business hours at Carver Country Flowers at 109 Third Street East in downtown Carver. Questions, contact John at 952.361.3149 or Annette at 952.681.7582.

Hoopin' Hips Fitness

Mondays....no experience necessary. Winter II – February 20th through March 19th at Carver Village Hall from 6:15 to 7 PM, Don't have to be a master at the hoop. Hoopin' Hips will emphasize core strengthening, conditioning and stability. The results are improved endurance, coordination, balance and some rock hard abs. Also includes free weights segments for muscle sculpting. Bring a water bottle.

Winter II also offering Total Body Conditioning, Tuesdays and Saturdays February 21st through March 20th. A high energy, calorie burning, cardio and strength training workout. Zumba Dance Thursdays is February 23rd through March 22nd. This is a popular fitness program inspired by Latin dance. Cardio – Kick Fitness on Mondays is scheduled for February 20th through March 19th. Interested in any of these, contact Kristy at 952.448.2290 at extension #2.

For a final class to consider, CPR on Tuesday, February 21st from 6 PM until 10 PM. Do you know what to do in an emergency? Call Kristy and check it out.

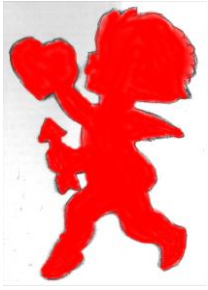
Carver Lions

The Carver Lions are always welcoming new members. If you are interested in just checking it out, please come to one of their meetings. They meet the first and third Wednesday of each month during the winter months at 6:30 PM in the Village Hall. There are lots of neat and nice people who do lots and lots of community things for the community. It's a very prestigious organization. Come and visit. You won't regret your decision one bit.

St Nicholas Catholic Church

Pancakes, French Toast and "homemade" sausage Breakfast will be Served at the St Nicholas Catholic Church's Parish Center on February 5th, Sunday from 8 AM until noon. There is a family rate available for $ 20. The cost is $ 7 for adults, $ 4 for children from the ages of 5 through 10 and children under four can eat free. Be sure to please come and join the fun, laughter and a spectacular "All You Can Eat" Breakfast this Sunday.

Happy Valentine's Day



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Carver Current

Be sure to check out Dan's website for his news and the news from the *Villager Tower*, as well as others. There is a lot of interesting information on his website. Also, when you need to get information out, contact Dan to submit. It's another great way for transmitting information all over. What is the website again? www.carvercurrent.com

"Villager Tower"

Ricki Yvonne Schultz
14210 Jonathan
Carver Parkway
Carver MN 55315
952 . 448 . 5126
villagertower@carvercurrent.com



For Sale

On fifty gallon aquarium for sale with its stand....that' right, the other one is gone. Great deal. Even has fish with it. Hurry, it's only $ 75. A steal really. Call 952.448.5126 or e-mail villager tower @ carvercurrent.com.

Also for sale are four collectible plates. "Faces of Nature Collection" by Julie Kraemer Cole is available. There were eight in the entire set. We have four available. Pictures below. These are amazing collector's plate celebrating the natural and spiritual beauty of the American West. The pictures feature magnificent Native American vistas, each with nature's faces hidden within the landscape. The technique of partially concealing images within a scene. For more information contact the *"Villager Tower"*.

Plate Four,
"Wolf Pack of the Ancients"



Plate Six
"Wintering With the Wapiti"



Plate Seven
"Within Sunrise"



Plate Eight
"Wambli Okiye"



Help Dorothy's daughter, Sara FIGHT Melanoma

Join us at
DAN PATCH AMERICAN LEGION
12375 Princeton Avenue in Savage
on Friday, February 17, 2012
from 7pm to Midnight!
$10.00 ADMISSION

This benefit will help raise funds necessary for Sara to get the most effective treatment for advanced stage Melanoma Skin Cancer

Free Beer | **RAFFLES** | **Silent Auction**

AWESOME PRIZES INCLUDE

Jewelry; Scarves, Gift Cards to Applebee's & Buffalo Tap, Paintings and the finest handmade Crown Royal Quilt & much more…

ENJOY LIVE MUSIC BY THE:

Elijah Adam Band
Elijahadamband.com



Sara's Story



In January of 2011, after having a mole removed and biopsied, Sara learned the results tested positive for Melanoma; the most serious form of skin cancer. Her care team planned to work ahead of the fast moving storm of cancer cells by removing the mole and all surrounding tissue, as well as six lymph nodes; one which tested positive for Melanoma. After a period of time was given for her to heal, Sara began daily treatments of chemotherapy for five weeks, and despite the horrific side effects, Sara remained a fighter. Body scans were performed every 8 to 12 weeks and it appeared that she was on her way out of the woods.

The summer of 2011 included several visits to the doctor for general tests and thorough examinations of her skin. We were all getting back to our regular routines and relieved to finally breathe and sleep easier.

But the nightmare started all over again just a few months later when the melanoma returned; in the same exact place, and with vengeance. The tumors were growing at an alarming rate beginning at the previous surgical incision as well as moving outward in all directions. Sara had surgery again to remove the tumors and was scheduled to undergo radiation treatments following her healing time. However; before she could begin those treatments, additional tumors began to grow just 2 weeks into her recovery. Again, Sara was back in surgery.

The current survival rate considering where she is at in this progressively late stage melanoma gives her just a 24% chance of living another two years. Her chances increase however, to 80%, if she is able to undergo an intensive late stage melanoma chemotherapy treatment that is received after a medically induced coma and while in ICU.

We are *begging* for everyone to help us raise the funds to get Sara the treatment. No donation is too small. Please help Sara in the fight for her life. Any *Wells Fargo branch will accept a donation to the:*

WELLS FARGO

SARA SATTLER BENEFIT FUND
You can also mail a check payable to

SARA SATTLER BENEFIT
C/O Dawn Oberman
7512 Bristol Village Drive
Bloomington, MN, 55438

DONATIONS FOR SARA

Please feel free to contact Dawn Oberman for further information at (952) 405-9286 or, email her at dawndi_dawn67@comcast.net

Special thanks to the following for their generous support
Dan Patch American Legion; Elijah Adam Band; Super America; Perrier; Bristol Village Townhomes; Dawn Oberman; Sue Oberstar; and many, many, more!



Andrew's Sight

Meet Andrew Steines. He is a 4th grade student at East Union who has been diagnosed with a degenerative eye disease. He will eventually lose his sight. The EUE PTO would like to make our school community aware of three different ways you can help Andrew and his family.

1. Donate money to assist in the medical expenses, for the purchase of a laptop to enlarge textbooks for school work and an e-reader that can turn books to audio text. You can give directly to Andrew's Sight Donation Fund at
Wells Fargo
400 North Chestnut Street
Chaska MN 55318

Carver Lion's Soggy Bottom Golf Tournament held in January. Half of the proceeds are for to Andrew's care.



3. Participate in the Ribbon Drive. Visit Andrew's Caring Bridge site for more details or Call Rachel Steines at 763-458-2564.

Follow Andrew's treatment on his Caring Bridge website at
www.caringbridge.org/visit/andrewsight

Sponsors

Rob Hagerstrom
rhagerstrom@posconinc.com

POSITIVE CONNECTIONS
Transportation Services

460 Hickory Street
Chaska, MN 55318

952/361-0899
Cell 952/210-7854
Fax 952-448-4135

Carver Lions

www.carverlions.org

New Members Welcome

CCYBSA
Carver Community Youth
Baseball Softball Association

Where the ball game begins

Find us on line at: www.cityofcarver.com

Questions? Email us at: ccybsa.reg@gmail.com

CARVER TAX SERVICE
TAX PREPARATION AND REPRESENTATION
CATHY L. STEIGERWALD, E.A.
ENROLLED AGENT
952.240.5279 Phone
952.368.6050 Fax
221 Broadway • P.O. Box 221
Carver, MN 55315
carvertax@comcast.net
www.carvertaxservice.com

Dunn Bros Coffee
Chaska
100 East 2nd St. Suite 100Chaska, MN 55318
Located in Historic Downtown Chaska, the building has been renovated and won the 2006 Minnesota Preservation Award. A cornerstone of Chaska's Walnut Street Historic District, the building started as a dry goods store in 1876 and was restored in 2005 where it now serves coffee and bakery items to patrons of Dunn Bros Coffee

Phone: 952-361-3011
email: dunnbros74@dunnbros.com
Location Map
Hours of Operation:
Mon- Fri: 6am-8pm
Sat: 6:30am-8pm
Sun: 7am-6pm

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